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Search Committee
Department of Economics
Auburn University
Auburn, AL 36849
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track Assistant/Associate Professor position in the Department of Economics at Auburn University, beginning Fall 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Auburn University's Department of Economics invites applicants with specialization in macroeconomics or international economics and emphasizes high-quality publication, teaching at both graduate and undergraduate levels, and service contributions. The broad field search and the opportunity to join a collaborative R1 research environment fit well with my training. I am excited about contributing to Auburn's research mission, mentoring both undergraduate and graduate students, and engaging in departmental and professional service that strengthens the department's profile.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro-policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students "convince themselves" that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured

office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Auburn, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Econometrics*, and I look forward to mentoring graduate students and engaging across research and teaching contributions.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate quantitative models that speak to macroeconomic and international-economic questions, and (iii) mentor students effectively in a research-active environment that values publication, teaching, and service. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to join Auburn University's Department of Economics and to contribute to its research, teaching, and service missions.

I would be honored to join your faculty at Auburn University. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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